



The *Daily Mirror's* target audience, according to ABC data, is predominantly C2DE, over 35 and are working-class Labour supporters.

The *Daily Mirror* is aware that their audience is generally concerned with social justice, the state of public services and does not support the policies of the Conservative and other right-wing parties. They enjoy sport, celebrity news and human interest stories that are personalised and reflect their everyday reality. The *Daily Mirror* states that its mission is to, 'make sense of a rapidly changing world for our readers. To challenge wrongs where we see them. To stand up for the underdog against authority' (Daily Mirror, n.d.).



Think!

Consider what evidence you have found in the issue that you have studied that supports the **audience profile** of the newspaper.

How media industries target audiences through the content and appeal of media products and through the ways in which they are marketed, distributed and circulated

- The front page of the newspaper is important in attracting an audience, particularly for popular, tabloid-style newspapers. The choice and style of the main headline and central image are important in attracting the reader and in communicating the viewpoint the newspaper is taking on the particular story featured. For example, the headlines 'Farage Can't Be Trusted With Britain' and 'Same Old Tories...Same Old Reform..' from January 2026 use emotive language to express their opinion about the right-wing parties. (The Paperboy, n.d.).
- Other pages in the newspaper and on digital platforms should be studied to explore the ideology of the newspaper including the editorial 'The Voice of the Mirror', the letters pages and opinion pieces.
- The newspaper's values, attitudes and representations of stories will resonate with like-minded readers who may have chosen this newspaper because of its left-wing stance. Readers will be made to feel part of the newspaper's community and that the stories and articles reflect their views. This audience will accept the **preferred reading** of the newspaper.
- Newspapers have had to adapt to survive, and the *Daily Mirror* has achieved this using new technologies to attract and maintain audiences. In December 2025, the *Daily Mirror's* website was fourth in the top fifty websites with 20.5 million monthly readers (Press Gazette, 2025). Digital platforms also enable the readers to interact with the newspaper and they are encouraged to post comments on the stories featured. In the 'Got a Story' section of the newspaper's website users are encouraged to submit their stories, pictures and videos so encouraging **citizen journalism**. Distributing the publication across digital platforms which allows it to be interactive and immediate will also appeal to younger audiences.

Theoretical perspectives

Cultivation theory – Gerbner

Gerbner asserts that audience exposure to repeated patterns of representation, such as that of the failure of the Brexit deal, the state of the economy or of the government in power, by